



It's colourful, its funky and yes, it's Linux. Personalise Tux by changing the look and feel of your favourite window manager. Here is how you do it.

Tweaking the appearance of the Windows desktop is a breeze—a few clicks, and you can change just about everything, from backgrounds to themes. If you are new to Linux, it's about time you discovered how easy it is to be get a desktop as colourful as Windows. Sure, it may seem confusing at first, with Linux distributions coming up with variations of the Gnome and KDE desktop environments, and a plethora of window managers to control the appearance of windows within these desktop environments. But here's the interesting part—within Linux, you can tweak just about every component of the window manager beyond what any version of Windows allows.

For this workshop, we show you how to put to use two of the most popular win-

dow managers in Linux—WindowMaker and Metacity. We put these window managers through their paces on a computer with the SuSE Linux Office Desktop distribution installed.

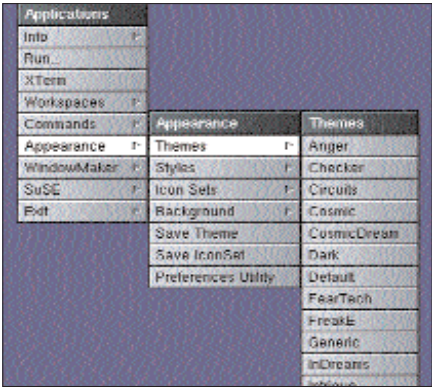
Using WindowMaker on SuSE

You can select the window manager or desktop environment right at the login screen. To use WindowMaker, select WindowMaker from the drop down box that appears at the login dialog.

The default environment and theme in WindowMaker is very different from what you get to see in your typical Windows desktop, and takes some time to get used to it. If it appears rather drab and insipid, this is how you can enliven it—click anywhere on the desktop, then, go to **Appearance >**

Themes. Experiment with the available themes listed in that menu. This should brighten your desktop quite a bit.

A theme defines the look of every



Changing themes in WindowMaker